



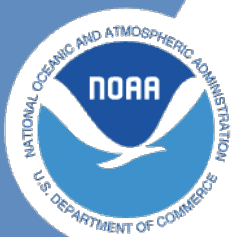
NOAA Technical Memorandum NMFS-XXX-##

# Marine Ecosystems of the United States

Marine Ecosystem Division / Ecosystem  
Assessment Branch

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE  
National Oceanic and Atmospheric  
Administration  
National Marine Fisheries Service  
Northwest Fisheries Science Center



**NOAA  
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1. NOAA Fisheries, Office of Science and Technology

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# 1 Introduction

## 2 About this report

The Marine Ecosystems of the United States (MEUS) report synthesizes environmental, oceanographic, ecological, and fisheries information to describe changing conditions across U.S. marine ecosystems. The report brings together a suite of indicators that characterize physical and biological conditions, ecosystem processes, and factors that may affect living marine resources and fisheries.

MEUS provides a national framework for examining patterns of ecosystem change and placing regional conditions within a broader U.S. context. Indicators are selected based on their relevance to understanding ecosystem conditions, their ability to capture meaningful changes over time, and the availability of consistent data. The report draws on established monitoring programs, research products, and other sources of information to provide a repeatable basis for tracking ecosystem conditions from year to year.

Information in this report is organized around indicators and synthesis products that describe major patterns and changes observed across U.S. marine ecosystems. Individual indicators provide information about specific environmental or ecological conditions, while synthesis products bring multiple indicators together to examine broader patterns of ecosystem change.

The report is intended to support ecosystem assessment, scientific synthesis, and fisheries management by providing accessible information on the environmental context in which U.S. fisheries operate. The indicators and synthesis presented here can also help identify emerging patterns and areas where additional investigation may be warranted.

This report was created in Quarto (<https://github.com/quarto-dev/quarto-cli/>) using the NOAA Quarto book template (<https://github.com/nmfs-opensci/NOAA-quarto-book>). The associated GitHub repository contains the data, code, figures, and other materials used to develop the report.

### **3 The Changing Baseline**

In this section, we report indicators that describe long-term changes in the physical and ecological conditions of U.S. marine ecosystems. These indicators provide context for understanding how conditions in a given year compare with longer-term patterns and trends.

## 4 Risks to meeting fishery management objectives

 Editing this template page

Template text is pulled from the 2025 Caribbean Ecosystem Status Report. Adjust accordingly.

In this section, we report indicators that capture identified risks to the ecosystem that could impact the ability to meet Fishery Management Plan objectives. Unless otherwise specified, physical indicators reported for the U.S. Caribbean region were calculated over a bounding box with limits of longitude 68 degrees W to 64.5 degrees W and latitude 17.5 degrees N to 18.75 degrees N.

## **5 Integrated ecosystem perspectives**

Synthesis

## **6 Research recommendations**

Recommendations

## **7 Acknowledgments**

### **7.1 Contributions**

This report would like to acknowledge the efforts and contributions of:

### **7.2 Resources**

This repo and GitHub Action associated with generating this report was based on the Openscapes tutorial `quarto-website-tutorial` by Julia Lowndes and Stefanie Butland.

## **8 Contributors**

### **8.1 Editors**

xxx

### **8.2 Contributors**

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## References